

SECURITY WATCH

Google spots new Hermit spyware on Android and iOS

Google's Project Zero and Threat Analysis Group (TAG) have come forward with their findings on the activities of an Italian spyware maker, RCS Labs. It has reportedly been around for a few years and has been used on people in Italy, Kazakhstan, and Syria. TAG is currently tracking more than 30 spyware vendors that have grown into a full-blown ecosystem and lends their services to world governments.

The spyware will be masked as a fake My Vodafone app that is pushed to the users through an SMS link and they are tricked into installing the app. According to Project Zero member Ian Beer, the exploits were successful in the first place, because of the new "system-on-a-chip" and "coprocessors" used in the recent iPhones, something which is used by Android phones too.

MOBILE WATCH

Xiaomi 12 Ultra

Xiaomi could soon launch the Xiaomi 12 Ultra with Leica-



branded cameras and a unique design. The brand announced its strategic partnership with Leica and revealed that the results of their combined efforts could come to fruition in July 2022. Now, we have stumbled upon purported live images of the Xiaomi 12 Ultra thanks to a Twitter user named Shadow_Leak. The photos showcase a ginormous camera hump and towards the top right corner lies a Leica logo. The camera setup is rumoured to house a 50 MP (w/OIS) primary camera, a 48 MP periscope telephoto shooter, and a 48 MP ultrawide snapper. The other rumoured specifications include the Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Plus Gen 1 SoC, a 5000 mAh battery, a 120 W fast charging, and a 6.73-inch 2K 120 Hz Samsung AMOLED display. That's what we know so far about the upcoming Xiaomi flagship.

MOBILE WATCH

Google Pixel 7 Pro

Google Pixel 7 Pro is slated to launch in the fall. And, as is tradition, Google is struggling to keep itself away from leaks. The company had shown off the phone's outer design at the Google I/O 2022. But a new leak (via AndroidPo-

lice) has divulged the design of its underlying chipset, i.e., Tensor 2 SoC. The discovery comes from people in the Google News Telegram channel who first got a Pixel 7 prototype. Although the device was in a bricked state, they then managed to mine details about Tensor 2 SoC and other Pixel 7 Pro specifications from the device boot logs. The first of the findings is that the Pixel 7 Pro will be using a Samsung S6E3HC4 panel on the front. This will be an upgrade over the Pixel 6 Pro's Samsung S6E3HC3 display. Speaking of upgrades, the second-gen Tensor processor doesn't seem to be much of one. The boot logs reveal the phone features Cortex A55 cores which is part of the Arm V8 design and so that hints at what the rest of the setup could be. Our guess is 2x Cortex X1+ 2x Cortex A78+ 4x Cortex A55. Since this isn't much different from the original Tensor SoC, the performance gains are likely to be slight. Besides these, we learn the codenames for the forthcoming Pixel 7 phones — "Panther" for the regular Pixel 7, and "Cheetah" for the Pixel 7 Pro.



APP WATCH

Calendar Notification

7. This is a free app that presents the calendar as a persistent notification. It lets you view a single day or a whole month at once. However, and other customisations unlock at a premium of ₹460.

Glimesh: Live Streaming

▶ This live streaming app uses a FTL protocol to allow audiences to view streams without much delay. Their financial statements are public to show its transparency.

Microsoft Lists

■ Microsoft Lists is a productivity tool for Office 365 users. It lets you manage work, track information and remain organised. The app comes with an array of collaboration tools to include coworkers as well.